

The Planning Commission / NITI AAYOG

*The Planning Commission was established by an executive resolution of the Government of India on **15 March, 1950**. *It was **neither a Constitutional body nor a statutory body**. *It was established on the recommendation of an advisory planning board chaired by **K.C. Neogy**. Prime Minister used to be its ex-officio chairman. *First Vice-chairman of the planning commission was **Guljari Lal Nanda**. *Its main function was to prepare five-year plans for the central government. *The Planning commission was replaced by '**NITI Aayog**' on 1 January, 2015. *NITI refers to **National Institution for Transforming India**. *Current Vice Chairman of NITI Aayog is **Dr. Suman K. Beri**. *Its Chief Executive officer is **B.V.R. Subrahmanyam**. *The rank and status of its vice-chairperson is equivalent to a Cabinet minister. *The **National Development Council** was established on 6 August, 1952.

1. The Planning Commission has been abolished by Prime Minister

- (a) Narendra Modi
- (b) Morarji Desai
- (c) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- (d) I.K. Gujral

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

The Planning Commission was set up in March 1950 by the first Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru to optimize scarce resources in newly-born Nation. Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced on August 15, 2014, from the Red Fort to abolish the old Planning Commission. In accordance with a key announcement made by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Independence Day, the Union Government established NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India), as a replacement for the Planning Commission on January 1, 2015. NITI Aayog will seek to provide a critical directional and strategic input into the developmental process.

2. NITI Aayog was established in India in January 2015 by :

- (a) Ordinance issued by President
- (b) The Act of Parliament

- (c) Union Cabinet passing a special resolution
- (d) None of the above

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Replacing planning commission on which of the following day 'NITI Aayog' came into existence?

- (a) 15th August 2014 (b) 6th December 2014
- (c) 1st January 2015 (d) 26th January 2015

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Who appoints the Vice Chairman of NITI Aayog?

- (a) The President of India.
- (b) The Prime Minister of India.
- (c) The Vice President of India.
- (d) The Speaker of the Lok Sabha.

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2022

Ans. (b)

On January 1, 2015, the NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) was established as the successor to the Planning Commission. It is a non-constitutional or extra-constitutional body (i.e., not created by the Constitution) and a non-statutory body (not created by an Act of the Parliament). It was created by an executive resolution of the Government of India. The Prime Minister is the ex-officio chairman of the NITI Aayog. A Vice-Chairperson is appointed by the Prime Minister. He enjoys the rank of a Cabinet Minister. Former World Bank economist, Suman Bery is the current vice-chairperson of the NITI Aayog. Dr. Arvind Pangariya served as the first vice-chairman of the NITI Aayog, from January, 2015 to August, 2017.

5. Who was the first Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog?

- (a) Rajiv Kumar (b) Amitabh Kant
- (c) Arvind Pangariya (d) Rao Inderjit Singh

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. When was the Planning Commission established?

- (a) 10th March, 1950 (b) 15th March, 1950

- (c) 16th March, 1951 (d) 20th March, 1950

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The Planning Commission was a non-Constitutional institution. It is not mentioned in the Constitution. The Commission was formed by a resolution of the Cabinet on March 15, 1950. Prime Minister used to be the ex-officio Chairman of this Commission. Its main function was to prepare a 5-year plan for the Union and to give suggestions on the annual plans of the States. Almost 70 percent grants to the States by the Centre were given on the recommendation of the Commission. NITI Aayog has replaced the Planning Commission. It is also an extra-Constitutional body. It has been formed by a resolution of the Union Cabinet on 1 January, 2015.

7. Planning Commission was established by-

- (a) Issuing ordinance by the President
(b) Making a law by Parliament
(c) A special resolution passed by the Union cabinet
(d) None of the Above

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Which of the following is an extra constitutional agency?

- (a) Union Public Service Commission
(b) Finance Commission
(c) Election Commission
(d) NITI Ayog

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. Which one of the following is an extra-Constitutional body?

- (a) Finance Commission
(b) NITI Aayog
(c) Election Commission
(d) Inter-State Council

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Which one of the following is not a Constitutional body?

- (a) Union Public Service Commission
(b) State Public Service Commission
(c) Finance Commission
(d) Planning Commission

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

The Union Public Service Commission and the Public Service Commissions for States under Article 315 and Finance Commission under Article 280 have been provided in the Constitution of India, while Planning Commission has not been mentioned in the Constitution. The Planning Commission is an extra-Constitutional body and was established in year 1950 by an executive order.

11. Which one of the following is not a Constitutional body?

- (a) Union Public Service Commission
(b) Finance Commission
(c) Planning Commission
(d) Election Commission

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. Which of the following is not a Constitutional organ?

- (a) Election Commission (b) Finance Commission
(c) Inter-State Council (d) Planning Commission

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

13. Which one of the following is not a Constitutional body?

- (a) Finance Commission
(b) Planning Commission
(c) Public Service Commission
(d) Election Commission

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

14. Which of the following body/bodies does not/do not find mention in the Constitution?

1. National Development Council
2. Planning Commission
3. Zonal Councils

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) Only 2
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) All of these

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

The National Development Council, the Planning Commission, and the Zonal Councils are not mentioned in the Constitution of India. These are extra-Constitutional bodies established by executive order. The National Development Council and the Planning Commission were established in 1952 and 1950 respectively, and the Zonal Councils are statutory bodies constituted under the State Reorganisation Act, 1956.

15. Who was the First Chairman of Planning Commission of India?

- (a) M. Viswesvaraya (b) Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) P. C. Mahalanobis (d) John Mathai

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

The Planning Commission was established on March 15, 1950 by a resolution of the Union Cabinet to make planning effective in India. Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru was the first chairman of the planning commission as the Prime Minister used to be the ex-officio chairman of this commission.

16. Who works as the Chairman of the Planning Commission?

- (a) President
(b) Prime Minister
(c) Vice-President
(d) Governor of Reserve Bank

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

17. The Ex-officio-Chairman of Planning Commission is—

- (a) President (b) Finance Minister

- (c) Vice-President (d) Prime Minister

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. Which one of the following is not correct about NITI Aayog?

- (a) It was set up to replace the Planning Commission
(b) It has a full-time Chairman
(c) It was set up in January 2015
(d) It is based on the principle of Cooperative Federalism

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India Aayog) is a Government of India policy think-tank, which came into being on 1 January, 2015 to replace the Planning Commission (Yojna Aayog). Like the Planning Commission, NITI Aayog is an extra-Constitutional body. This Aayog works on the principle of Co-operative federalism. Thus, all the above statements are true except that it has a full-time Chairman, because the Prime Minister is the ex-officio Chairperson of NITI Aayog which changes with the completion of the term of his office.

19. Who among the following is associated with 'NITI Aayog'?

- (a) Narendra Modi (b) Kaushik Basu
(c) Amartya Sen (d) P. Chidambaram

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Niti Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) is a Government of India Policy think tank, which came into being on 1 January, 2015 in place of the Planning Commission. Current Chairperson of Niti Aayog is Shri Narendra Modi as the Prime Minister is the ex-officio Chairman of NITI Ayog.

20. The Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission is equivalent to—

- (a) Vice-President
(b) Minister of the State
(c) Cabinet Minister
(d) Judge of the Supreme Court

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

The Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission is equivalent to a Cabinet Minister of Indian Government. Gulzarilal Nanda was the first Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission.

21. The importance given to the Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission in the official hierarchy of the Government is that of –

- (a) A Cabinet Minister in the Government of India
- (b) A Supreme Court Judge
- (c) Chairman of a Parliamentary Committee
- (d) A Secretary to the Government of India

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

22. Who among the following has not been the Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission in India?

- (a) Dr. Manmohan Singh
- (b) Pranab Mukherjee
- (c) P. Chidambaram
- (d) Montek S. Ahluwalia

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

P. Chidambaram was never the Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission, while Dr. Manmohan Singh (1985-1987), Pranab Mukherjee (1991-1996), Montek Singh Ahluwalia (2004-2014) have served as the Deputy Chairmen of the Planning Commission.

23. Given below are two statements, one labelled as assertion (A) and the other labelled as Reason (R):

Assertion (A) : Planning Commission has been defined as the economic cabinet, not merely for the Union but the States also.

Reason (R) : It formulates the five-year plans for the balanced utilization of natural resources.

In context of the above statements, which one of the following is correct?

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

The Planning Commission formulates the five-year plans for the balanced utilization of natural resources. It is called the 'Economic Cabinet' of the Union and States due to extra-Constitutional discretionary powers and comprehensive nature of the reference topics. Thus Assertion and Reason both are individually correct but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A). Thus option (b) is correct.

24. Who had suggested a merger of Finance and Planning Commission?

- (a) D. D. Basu
- (b) Bhalchandra Goswami
- (c) M.V. Mathur
- (d) Ashutosh Pandey

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

The suggestion for merging the Planning Commission and Finance Commission was given by M.V. Mathur. Sri M. V. Mathur was one of the members of the 3rd Finance Commission which was formed in 1960.

25. When was the National Development Council formed in India?

- (a) 26th January, 1950
- (b) 2nd October, 1950
- (c) 6th August, 1951
- (d) 6th August, 1952

U.P.P.C.S (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

National Development Council (NDC) was formed on 6th August, 1952 .

26. Which one of the following statements is not true?

- (a) Prime Minister is the Chairman of the Planning Commission of India.
- (b) Planning Commission is the highest decision-making body for planning in India.
- (c) Secretary of the Planning Commission is also the Secretary of the National Development Council.
- (d) The National Development Council is presided over by the Prime Minister of India.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

The National Development Council (NDC) is the apex body for decision-making and deliberation on development matters in India. It is presided over by Prime Minister. It is comprised of the Prime Minister as the Chairman of the Commission, Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission (now NITI Aayog), Chief Ministers, Cabinet Ministers and the Members of the Planning Commission (now NITI Aayog). The other 3 options are true.

- 27. The National Development Council (NDC) –**
- 1. Discusses the progress of the National Plan.**
 - 2. Suggests the ways to achieve the goals of the National Plan.**
 - 3. Gives guidelines to formulate the National Plan.**
 - 4. Suggests allocation of money in Planning.**
- Considering the above statements, select the correct answer from the code given below :**

Codes :

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------------|
| (a) 1, 2, and 3 | (b) 2, 3 and 4 |
| (c) 1, 2 and 4 | (d) All of the above |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

The National Development Council (NDC) was set up on 6 August, 1952 by an executive order of the Government. Its main functions are:

- (a) To prescribe guidelines for the formulation of the National Plan, including the assessment of resources for the plan;
- (b) To consider the National Plan as formulated by the Planning Commission;
- (c) To consider important questions of social and economic policy affecting National development;
- (d) To review the working of the Plan from time to time and to recommend such measures that are necessary for achieving the aims and targets set out in the National Plan. The Planning Commission suggested ways for the allocation of money to National Plan not the National Development Council.

- 28. Which of the following is the main function of National Development Council in India?**

- (a) To activate the means and efforts of states for implementation of the planning.
- (b) To develop the general policies in all the important areas.
- (c) To confirm the balanced development in all the areas of the country
- (d) All of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

- 29. Who among the following constitutes the National Development Council?**

- 1. The Prime Minister**
- 2. The Chairman, Finance Commission**
- 3. Ministers of the Union Cabinet**
- 4. Chief Ministers of the States**

Select the correct answer using the code given below?

- | | |
|---------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Only 1, 2 and 3 | (b) Only 1, 3 and 4 |
| (c) Only 2 and 4 | (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The National Development Council was established in August, 1952. It consists of the following members- (1) Prime Minister as its Chairman, (2) Ministers of the Union Cabinet, (3) Chief Ministers of all the states, (4) Chief Minister/ Administrators of the Union Territories, (5) Members of the Planning Commission (now, NITI Aayog).

- 30. National Development Council is primarily related to –**

- (a) Approval of five-year plans
- (b) Execution of village development plans
- (c) Formation of development plans
- (d) The financial relation between States and Union.

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

To ensure the participation of States in the formation of five-year plans, the National Development Council (NDC) was set up on 6 August, 1952 by an executive order of the Government. The Prime Minister is the Chairman of the National Development Council and all the Chief Ministers of the States are its members. The Secretary of the Planning Commission (now, NITI Aayog) is also the Ex-officio Secretary of the National Development Council. NDC finally approves five years plans. NDC acts as a coordinator between the planning commission (now, NITI Aayog) and State Governments.

- 31. Who acts as the Secretary of National Development Council (NDC)?**

- (a) Secretary, Ministry of Finance
- (b) Secretary, Ministry of Planning
- (c) Secretary, Planning Commission
- (d) Secretary, Finance Commission

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.